

What's the damage?

Industrialization is also damaging the environment. Obvious examples are the smoky factories and diesel trucks that ruin air quality in cities, but there are other serious problems. Emissions of greenhouse gases, like CO₂, cause global warming, which is leading to changes to our climate that threaten food production, and extreme weather conditions and rising sea levels that are destroying property and disrupting businesses. Industry affects agricultural production in other ways, too. Pollution poisons our land, rivers, and seas, and farmland is used instead for manufacturing industries or extracting mineral resources. Attempts to increase agricultural production by clearing vast areas of rain forest, using herbicides and pesticides, and developing genetically modified crops, can upset the balance of ecosystems. The cost of industry's damage to the environment is already huge, and unless things change, it will put an end to the industrial era and its ever-increasing prosperity. It's as much an economic issue as a scientific one and it needs economic as well as scientific measures to solve it.

**THE KEY TO UNDERSTANDING THE FUTURE IS
ONE WORD: SUSTAINABILITY.**

PATRICK DIXON, BRITISH TRENDS FORCASTER

Punishing polluters

Economic measures could include making polluting companies pay more tax. Taxes on greenhouse gas emissions, or toxic waste, would push industries to find cleaner methods of production, while giving governments money to deal with the issues caused by pollution. Governments can also put caps, or limits, on emissions and punish industries that exceed their quotas, the amounts they're allowed to emit. In a system of emissions trading, non-